

Figure 3: Types of cartridges

Standalone cartridges: These are for programming languages or application servers.

Embedded cartridges: This type of cartridge is used to enhance the applications. These cartridges alone can't be used to build applications.

The OpenShift stack

The recent release of OpenShift has an improved stack as shown in Figure 4. This stack now includes Docker, Kubernetes and Project Atomic.

Docker: This is an open source tool. Docker packages the applications and the related dependencies as containers. It consists of an engine, and a lightweight runtime and packaging tool. For further information on Docker, visit <https://www.docker.com/whatisdocker/>. Stating it simply, Docker facilitates the creation of portable, self-sufficient application containers.

Kubernetes: This is an open source orchestration system. It can be used with Docker containers. Kubernetes is lightweight, portable and extensible. For detailed information on Kubernetes, visit <http://kubernetes.io/>. A cluster of Linux containers can be managed as a single system using Kubernetes.

Project Atomic: This is for deploying and managing Docker containers. Project Atomic is getting more popular in recent times due to its powerful features. Further information on Project Atomic is available at <http://www.projectatomic.io/>.

Covering every aspect of OpenShift is beyond the scope of a single article. For developers who want to get into the details of OpenShift, there is an excellent open book available at the official site: 'Getting Started with

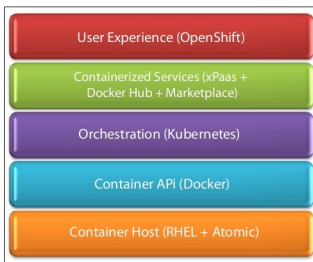


Figure 4: The OpenShift stack

OpenShift: A Guide for Impatient Beginners'. The book can be downloaded from <https://www.openshift.com/promotions/ebook/thanks>.

The open source nature of OpenShift Origin is its greatest advantage, allowing users to customise the PaaS according to the specific needs of an organisation. Its improved stack containing technologies make OpenShift a superb choice in the PaaS arena. 

References

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